1daily

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KNOWLEDGE BASE · TRADING METHOD

The 1daily *Method*

How we trade gold. Five conditions in a fixed order, clear rules for every entry and risk management without exceptions.



THE GUIDING PRINCIPLE

“We do not predict the market. We wait, with discipline, for confirmation from the forces that actually move it.”

PURPOSE

This document describes the official trading method of 1daily AG for gold (XAUUSD). It is the knowledge base for our own trading, for the development of Goldcheck and for all content in which we explain how we work.

STRUCTURE

An overview is followed by market understanding and mindset, then each of the five components in detail. Execution, economic news, risk management, position sizing and the role of technology complete the method. A checklist and a glossary make it usable every day.

IMPORTANT

The 1daily Method is a set of rules for analysis and decision-making. It is not investment advice and not a promise of profit. Trading CFDs involves a high risk of loss. The full risk warning is at the end of this document.

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FOREWORD

Why we need a method

Exceptional results do not come from single big moments, but from thousands of small decisions made every day according to the same rules.

1daily AG was founded on a simple conviction: real progress is not dramatic, it is daily. One percent of improvement a day changes everything over a year. That holds true in endurance sport, in entrepreneurship and above all in the financial markets.

Financial markets are the most complex decision-making environment people have ever created. Trading them without a system is not a craft but gambling. Experience shows the same pattern again and again: it is not the wrong market view that destroys trading capital, but a chain of small rule violations. Profits are not secured, losses are not accepted, positions are increased to win back losses. In the end a correct market view often sits next to an empty account.

The 1daily Method is our answer. It defines where we trade, when we trade, how we enter, where we exit and how much we risk. It takes the weight off the individual decision and places it on the process. A trade is no longer a matter of intuition but the result of a test: are all five conditions met or not?

The method follows the footprints of institutional capital. Large market participants need liquidity, and they find it where the stop orders of the majority cluster. Whoever understands this mechanism changes sides: from liquidity provider to a disciplined companion of the large capital flows.

Technology does not replace human judgement; it strengthens it. Goldcheck provides the analysis, people make the decision, and 1daily Guard protects capital in exactly those moments when emotions are strongest. The result is a system that does not depend on form on the day, hope or fear.

This knowledge base describes the method in full. It is deliberately detailed, because discipline begins with understanding. Those who know why a rule exists keep to it even when the market tempts them to break it.

"The summit was the result. The endurance was the achievement."

Ivan Schmid, founder of 1daily AG, on climbing Mount Everest via the Northeast Ridge in 2011

THE PROMISE

1% better. Every day.

No single trade decides anything. The system decides. Those who manage risk stay in the game; those who trust the process win in the long run.

CHAPTER 01

At a glance

01

The 1daily core setup in five conditions, and the rules that accompany every single trade.

THE METHOD IN ONE SENTENCE

We trade gold only at institutional price zones, only after proven liquidity has been taken, only once a change of direction is confirmed, and only with entry, stop-loss and target defined in advance.

The 1daily Method is a rule-based model for day trading gold against the US dollar (XAUUSD). It does away with the common reliance on single indicators, arbitrary entry signals and spontaneous decisions. Instead, it requires a fixed sequence of five conditions which together make the footprint of large market participants visible. If one condition is missing, there is no trade.

5	1%	3%	3	0
conditions for every trade	maximum risk per trade	maximum risk per day	positions at the same time	trades without a stop-loss

I

Sweep

Liquidity is taken. Price pierces a bank level, the majority's stops are triggered and absorbed by large opposing orders.

COMPONENTS 1 AND 2

II

Break

Structure breaks. An unusually large candle with clear momentum drives price away from the level.

COMPONENTS 3 AND 4

III

Unmitigated

Entry happens on the retracement. We wait with a limit order in the untested zone the break has left behind.

COMPONENT 5

THE 1DAILY CORE SETUP

Five conditions. One trade.

Each condition builds on the one before. The first two prove that liquidity has been taken, the next two confirm the change of direction, and the fifth defines the precise entry.

SWEEP
Take liquidity

BREAK
Break structure

UNMITIGATED
Enter on the retracement

1 Bank level

Price reaches an institutional price zone: a round number, a previous day's or week's extreme, or an extreme of the Asian session. This is where the clustered orders lie that large market participants need.

CHECK Is price at a bank level marked in advance?

2 Incomplete candle close

A candle pierces the level but closes back inside the previous range, leaving a long wick behind. The breakout has failed; liquidity has been taken.

CHECK Has the candle closed, and is the close back inside the range?

3 Candle leaves level > ATR

The candle moving away from the level is larger than the average range of the last 14 candles. Retail traders cannot move price like that: this is institutional pressure.

CHECK Does the range of the counter-candle exceed the ATR(14) on the same timeframe?

4 Momentum

Volume, cumulative delta and oscillators confirm that active orders are carrying the new direction. A sweep without volume remains suspect.

CHECK Is volume rising clearly, and is delta pointing in the new direction?

5 SBU entry

Entry is made with a limit order in the untested fair value gap or order block, with a stop-loss beyond the sweep wick and a target at the next bank level.

CHECK Are entry, stop-loss and target defined, and is the reward-to-risk ratio favourable?

TRADE Only when all five conditions are met. If a single one is missing, there is no trade, however much time went into the preparation.

CHAPTER 02

The market: why gold

02

Gold combines commodity and currency. Its liquidity, its movement and its clear drivers make it the market for our system.

A commodity that works like money

Gold has a dual nature. It is a physical commodity whose price is determined by mine production, recycling, jewellery, industry and investment demand. At the same time it is a monetary safe haven that has served as a store of value for thousands of years and offers protection against inflation, currency debasement and geopolitical crises.

XAU is the official ISO currency code for one troy ounce of gold, or 31.1035 grams. That is why gold is quoted like a currency pair: XAUUSD shows how many US dollars one ounce costs. This quotation explains why the gold price is so closely tied to the US dollar, US interest rates and the monetary policy of the US Federal Reserve.

USD 361 bn
average trading volume per day (2025)

23 hrs
of trading per day, Monday to Friday

100 oz
per standard lot of XAUUSD with most providers

What moves the gold price

DRIVER	EFFECT ON GOLD	RELEVANCE FOR THE METHOD
US dollar	A stronger dollar usually weighs on gold, a weaker one supports it.	Without US data, pairs such as EUR/USD often set the direction.
Interest rates	Gold pays no interest. Rising real rates reduce its relative appeal.	Statements by the Fed trigger abrupt moves.
Economic data	Jobs, inflation and growth shift rate expectations.	Fixed rules before and after releases (chapter 10).
Risk sentiment	Crises and shocks steer capital into the safe haven.	Moves often start abruptly; the stop-loss applies without exception.
Central banks, ETFs	Purchases and fund flows shift supply and demand over months.	They reinforce long-term bank levels.

A market that hardly sleeps

Liquidity follows the sun from Asia through Europe to America. The Asian session often forms a calmer range whose high and low later serve as bank levels. Activity rises markedly with the London open. The strongest moves usually occur when London and New York trade at the same time.

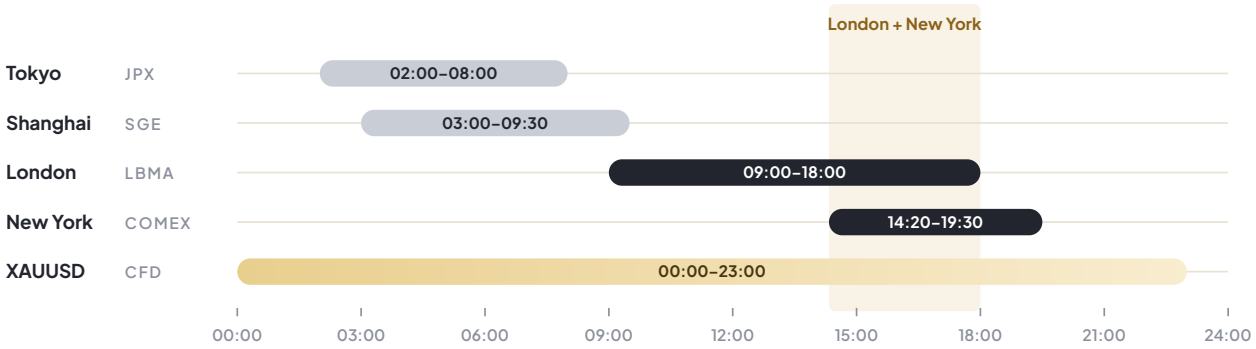


FIG. 1 Core trading hours of the main gold markets in Swiss time (summer time, as of October 2026). In winter, Tokyo and Shanghai start one hour earlier. CFD providers' trading hours may differ slightly.

What this means for the method

Volatility, and with it the average candle range, varies considerably by time of day. In 2026 the average daily range was around USD 120 per ounce. A fixed filter in dollars would be too strict at one time and too lenient at another. That is why the method measures moves in relative terms, with the Average True Range.

Why most retail traders lose

European providers must disclose the share of their retail accounts that lose money with CFDs. These figures typically range from 51 to 74 percent. The causes are almost always the same, and the method addresses exactly those.

CAUSE	WHAT HAPPENS	THE 1DAILY METHOD'S ANSWER
Lack of understanding of market structure	Entries in no man's land, in the middle of a move	Trades only at bank levels, entry only via the SBU sequence
Inadequate risk management	Positions too large, stops moved or missing	1% per trade, 3% per day, enforced technically
Vulnerability to false breakouts	Buying the breakout, selling in panic	The false breakout is not feared but used

CHAPTER 03

The mindset

03

Markets are not random. What is usually random is the unstructured approach of those who trade them.

PRINCIPLE 01

Structure over chaos

Many traders combine a multitude of independent indicators without a fixed model for entry, risk and exit. The result is noise mistaken for a signal. In the 1daily Method every element is fixed before an order is placed: the setup, the entry, the stop-loss and the target. What has not been defined in advance is not traded.

Outside signals, whether from groups, alerts or other people's opinions, never replace one's own judgement on the chart. That applies to Goldcheck too: the artificial intelligence provides context and probabilities; the person makes the decision based on the five conditions.

PRINCIPLE 02

Thinking in probabilities

A professional trader does not strive to be right with every trade. Every single transaction has an uncertain outcome. Only over a series does it become clear whether a rule set with positive expectancy has been applied consistently.

This view fundamentally changes how losses are handled. A losing trade is a planned operating cost of the system, not a personal failure and not a reason to abandon the system. That is why a stop-loss is never moved to avoid a loss.

Expectancy = win rate × avg. gain – loss rate × avg. loss

A system can be profitable with fewer than half of its trades winning, provided the gains are larger than the losses. Conversely, a high win rate is worthless if individual losses run without limit.

PRINCIPLE 03

Making emotional costs visible

A lack of emotional control costs measurable money. We call these costs emotional costs and treat them like any other cost item: they are recorded, named and systematically reduced. Trade management, the phase from entry to exit, is a skill of its own that most market participants underestimate.

FORM	TYPICAL TRIGGER	WHAT HAPPENS	THE METHOD'S ANSWER
Revenge trading	a loss shortly before	unplanned trades to win the loss back immediately	a pause after losses, enforced technically by 1daily Guard
Increasing position size	a losing streak	risk rises exactly when judgement is weakest	a fixed risk of 1% per trade, without exception
FOMO entry	a strong move without us	entry without a setup, poor price, wide stop	entry only with a limit order in the untested zone
Closing too early	a first paper profit, fear of a pullback	gains are cut short, losses run in full	the target at the next bank level is fixed before entry
Moving the stop	price approaches the stop-loss	a small loss becomes a large one	the stop-loss is never moved or widened
Fatigue	long sessions, lack of sleep	decisions become faster and worse	trading stops immediately when tired or stressed

The trading journal

Every trade is documented: bank level, time, fulfilment of the five conditions, entry, stop-loss, target, result and, just as important, the emotional state before and during the trade. If a decision deviates from the rule set, it is marked as an emotional cost.

Over time an honest picture emerges of how much money rule violations actually cost. That picture is the strongest motivation to give them up.

> *"The goal is execution that feels calm, unspectacular and almost boring, because discipline has replaced emotion."*
>
> From the mindset of the 1daily Method

CHAPTER 04

Bank level

04

Every trade begins at a price zone where large market participants find liquidity. Never in no man's land on the chart.

What a bank level is

The gold price does not move in a vacuum. It travels systematically from one liquidity zone to the next, drawn by concentrations of unfilled orders. Bank levels are the price coordinates where large institutional players, central banks and algorithmic systems find the volume they need to build or unwind large positions without moving the price against themselves through slippage.

The two kinds

Psychological round numbers. Gold has historically respected round price levels such as USD 4,000, 4,050 or 4,100 with remarkable precision. Macro funds and institutional hedgers often anchor their derivative positions exactly at these marks, and many market participants place their orders there.

Structural extremes. Even more important for day trading are earlier extremes: the previous day's high and low (PDH and PDL), the weekly high and low, and the extremes of the Asian session. These points are visible to everyone, and that is precisely why orders gather there.

Why liquidity sits there

Behind every prominent high lie the stop-loss orders of those holding short positions and the buy-stop orders of breakout traders hoping for a new move. Below every prominent low lies the mirror image. For large market participants these clustered orders are simply liquidity. Anyone wanting to build a large long position needs sellers, and finds them most efficiently in the form of triggered sell stops below a prominent low.

A trade opened far away from a bank level has no institutional support and therefore a considerably lower probability of success.

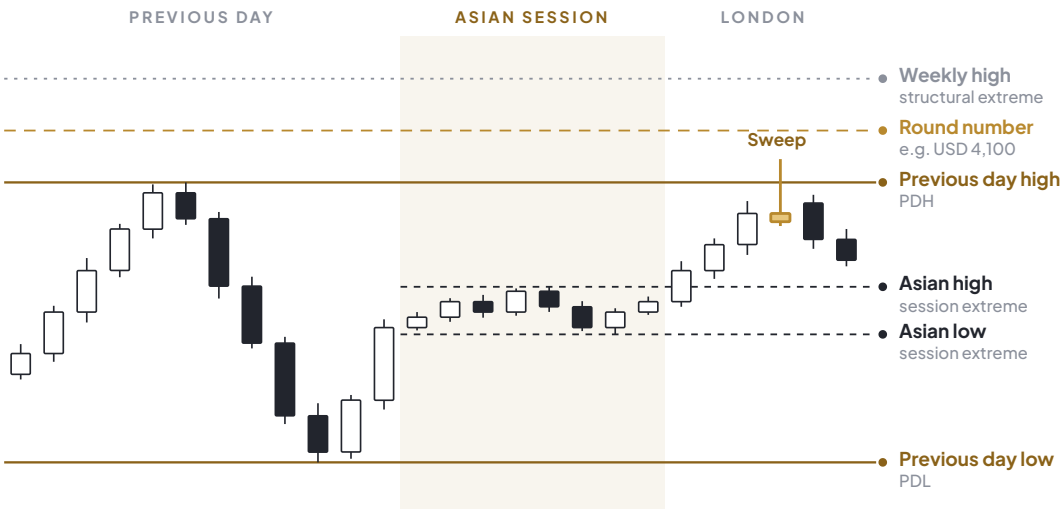


FIG. 2 The most important bank levels during the day. The high and low of the Asian session only form overnight and are added at the London open. Schematic illustration.

How we mark bank levels

- [ ] Before trading starts: the previous day's high and low (PDH, PDL)
- [ ] High and low of the current and previous week
- [ ] High and low of the Asian session, once London opens
- [ ] The nearest round numbers above and below the current price
- [ ] Zones, not lines: a level is a narrow area, not an exact price

RULE

No trades in no man's land on the chart. Every trade begins at a bank level marked in advance.

MACRO VALIDATION

The COT report

The Commitments of Traders report from the US regulator CFTC is published every Friday and shows positioning in the COMEX gold futures market as of Tuesday. Among other things, it distinguishes commercial hedgers from speculative managed money.

- **Commercials** such as miners and bullion banks hedge future sales prices and build net short positions when prices rise sharply. That forms a fundamental ceiling.
- **Managed money** such as hedge funds reacts sensitively to yields and inflation data and often liquidates long positions abruptly.
- When commercials cover their shorts while managed money capitulates, an institutional floor of the highest quality forms.

Central banks reinforce such zones further: in 2025 they bought around 863 tonnes of gold worldwide, often during price declines as well.

COMMON MISTAKE

Too many lines. Marking every small high means finding a level everywhere, and therefore nowhere.

COMMON MISTAKE

Drawing levels after the fact. Bank levels are set before trading starts, not adjusted to fit during the move.

CHAPTER 05

Incomplete candle close

05

The visible footprint of a liquidity grab: the candle pierces the level and closes back inside the range.

Definition

As soon as gold reaches a bank level, we watch the candle's reaction. An incomplete candle close occurs when a candle clearly pierces the level while it forms, but at the end of its period closes back inside the previous price range. A long wick is left beyond the level. In the language of Smart Money Concepts, this is the footprint of a liquidity sweep, a stop hunt.

The mechanics of the breakout trap

If gold breaks above the previous day's high, for example, many market participants pour into the market. Momentum algorithms and breakout traders buy in the expectation that resistance has been broken. At the same time, the stop-loss orders of short positions are triggered, which are technically buy orders as well.

This flood of buying liquidity meets large sell limits that institutional players have placed precisely at this level, and is absorbed by them. On the chart the process shows up as a failed breakout: price pierces the level clearly, usually on M15 or M30, but the strength for a real structural shift is missing. It is pushed back aggressively, and the candle closes back inside the range.

Trapped traders as fuel

Those who bought the breakout are now stuck in a losing position. The further price falls back, the greater the pressure to close these positions. These sales provide the fuel for the actual move in the opposite direction. This is exactly the move the 1daily Method trades.

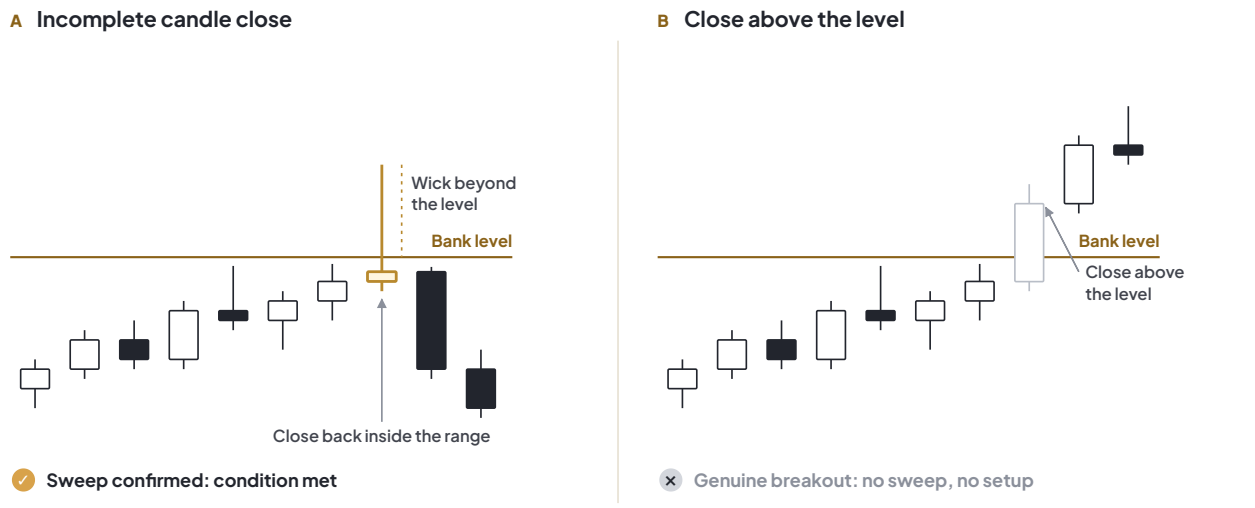


FIG. 3 Left, a valid sweep: wick above the level, close back inside the range. Right, a genuine breakout: close above the level. Schematic illustration.

Telling it apart from a genuine breakout

The incomplete-close condition protects against standing in the way of a real trend. Merely exceeding a level is not a sweep. It may just as well be the start of a legitimate breakout.

Only once the candle has closed and exposed the breakout as false is the condition met. This patience sometimes costs a few dollars on the entry price, but it prevents the most expensive mistakes.

How we recognise a valid sweep

- [ ] The candle has pierced a bank level marked in advance.
- [ ] The candle has fully closed.
- [ ] The close is back inside the previous range.
- [ ] The wick beyond the level is clearly visible.

RULE

Always wait for the candle to close. No close back inside the range, no setup.

COMMON MISTAKE

Anticipating. Entering while the candle is still forming, in the hope that it will fall back.

COMMON MISTAKE

Reading every wick as a sweep. Without a bank level, a wick is just a wick.

CHAPTER 06

Candle leaves level > ATR

06

A sweep is necessary but not sufficient. Only a candle larger than the average range proves real pressure.

Why a sweep alone is not enough

Markets can take out a level several times or move sideways after a sweep. To confirm the directional intent of large market participants, a third condition is required: the candle moving away from the level, the so-called displacement candle, must exceed the Average True Range in size.

The Average True Range

The ATR was introduced in 1978 by J. Welles Wilder Jr. in his book “New Concepts in Technical Trading Systems”. It measures the average true trading range over a defined period, by default 14 candles. The true range takes into account not only the high and low of the current candle but also gaps to the previous close. The result is a moving measure of absolute volatility, regardless of direction.

True range = the largest of
high − low
| high − previous close |
| low − previous close |

ATR(14) = (previous ATR × 13
+ current true range) ÷ 14

A filter that adapts

Gold’s volatility varies enormously by time of day. In the Asian session the ATR on M15 is small; at the New York open it jumps. A fixed threshold in dollars would be too strict at one time and too lenient at another. The ATR rule, by contrast, adapts automatically to the current market phase. It is always measured on the same timeframe as the candle being assessed.

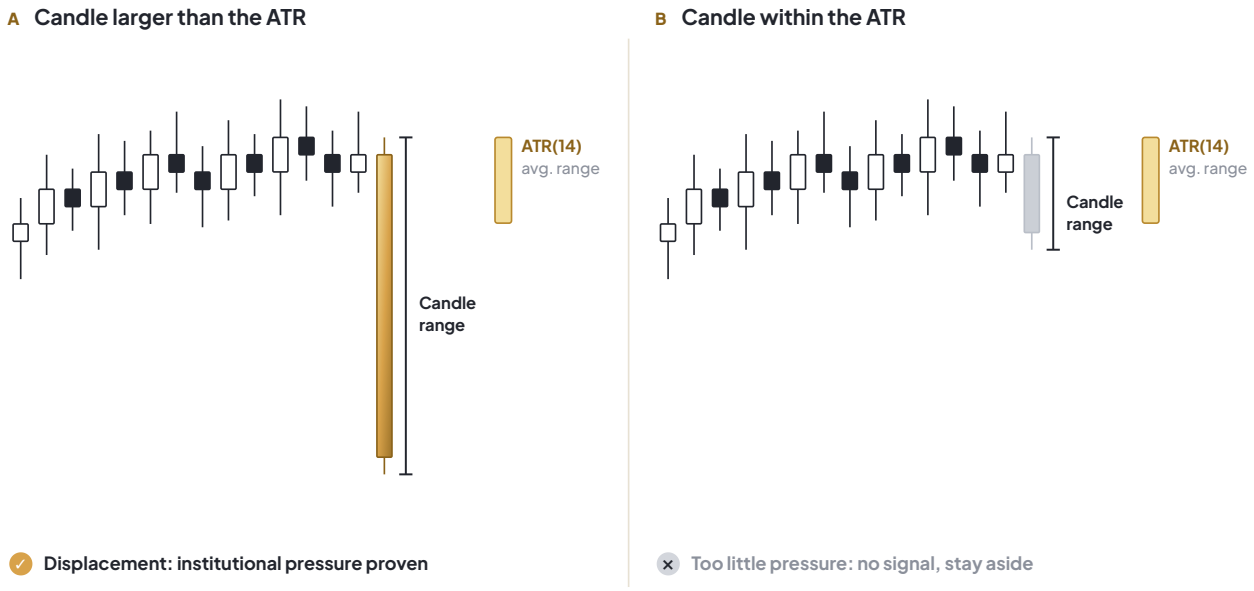


FIG. 4 Left, the counter-candle clearly exceeds the ATR and proves institutional pressure. Right, it stays within the average range: no signal. Schematic illustration.

Features of a valid displacement candle

- [ ] range larger than the ATR(14) on the same timeframe
- [ ] large body, small wicks
- [ ] often engulfs several preceding candles
- [ ] breaks local swing structure
- [ ] forms immediately after the sweep, away from the bank level

Why this candle reveals so much

Retail traders do not have the capital to move gold like this within a single interval. Such a candle is therefore strong evidence of institutional pressure. Newer approaches also combine the ATR with the rate of change and the volume-weighted average price (VWAP) to detect volatility spikes even more precisely.

RULE

If the candle after the sweep is smaller than the ATR, institutional pressure is missing. We stay on the sidelines.

COMMON MISTAKE

Wrong timeframe. An M15 candle is compared with the ATR of the M15 chart, not that of the hourly chart.

COMMON MISTAKE

Close is not valid. A candle that almost reaches the ATR does not meet the condition. The filter is binary.

CHAPTER 07

Momentum

07

The ATR measures how far price moves. Momentum shows with how much force.

Speed, volume, acceleration

The ATR filter measures the spatial extent of a move. The fourth component adds the dimensions of speed, volume and acceleration. Only when range and force match is the new direction considered confirmed.

Volume

The spot gold market is decentralised and has no central volume. Professional traders therefore use aggregated tick volume or data from COMEX gold futures. Genuine moves after a liquidity grab are marked by a sudden rise in volume, well above the average of recent periods. A sweep on low volume is suspect and often leads to an aimless return to consolidation.

Cumulative delta

Even more precise is the cumulative delta: the difference between aggressive buying executed at the ask and aggressive selling at the bid. If gold takes out a high and then forms a candle larger than the ATR to the downside, delta must turn clearly negative. This shows that not only passive limit orders turned the price, but that active sell orders are now driving the market lower.

Confirmation across timeframes

If the oscillators on the short-term chart, such as RSI and Stochastic on M5, signal exhaustion in sync with the higher-level structure on the daily chart, the quality of the signal rises markedly.

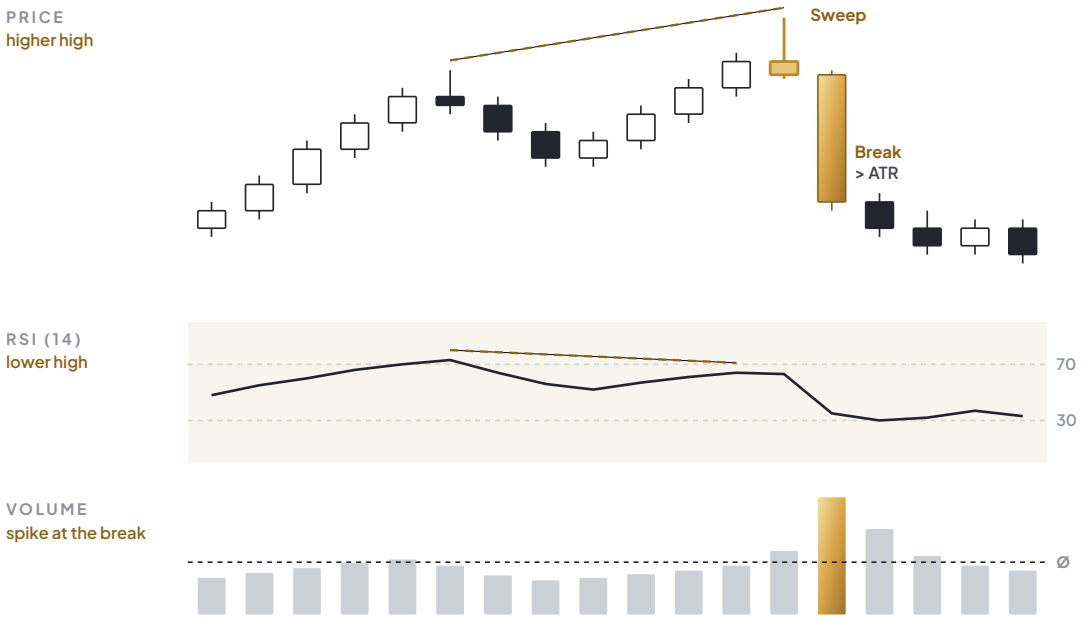


FIG. 5 Bearish divergence: price makes a higher high at the sweep, the RSI a lower one. At the break, volume spikes. Schematic illustration.

Supporting indicators and their role

INDICATOR	WHAT IT SHOWS	ROLE IN THE METHOD
Tick volume, delta	the force behind the move	mandatory check for component 4
RSI (14)	strength and pace; above 70 overbought, below 30 oversold	divergence at the sweep: new price high without a new RSI high
MACD (12, 26, 9)	trend changes and acceleration	confirms the change in momentum after the break
Stochastic, Williams %R	short-term extremes	a hint for timing, never in isolation
EMA 20 and EMA 50	the higher-level direction	aligns the trade with the institutional flow

RULE

A sweep without volume remains suspect. Indicators confirm price action; they never replace it.

CHAPTER 08

SBU: sweep, break, unmitigated

The sequence that turns observations into a precise entry.

08

The fifth component turns the preceding observations into a mechanical process. It prevents chasing prices and ensures that stop-loss and target are fixed before entry.

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS IN THE MARKET	IN THE CORE SETUP
Sweep	Price briefly breaks an extreme level. Stop orders are filled into large institutional opposing volume. The breakout fails.	Bank level and incomplete candle close
Break	A fast, directional move puts trapped traders under water. Local market structure is broken.	Candle larger than the ATR and momentum
Unmitigated	The move was so fast that zones with hardly any trading are left behind: fair value gaps and order blocks.	Precise entry on the retracement into this zone

Why we wait for the retracement

When the break candle forms the new direction, the undisciplined trader jumps in with a market order out of fear of missing the move. This leads to a poor entry price and requires a very wide stop-loss.

The disciplined trader instead identifies the inefficiency the break has left behind: the **fair value gap**, the price gap between the wick of the candle before and the candle after the break, or the **order block**, the last candle before the strong counter-move. Algorithms often bring price back into these untested zones to fill remaining orders and balance average prices before the actual move continues.

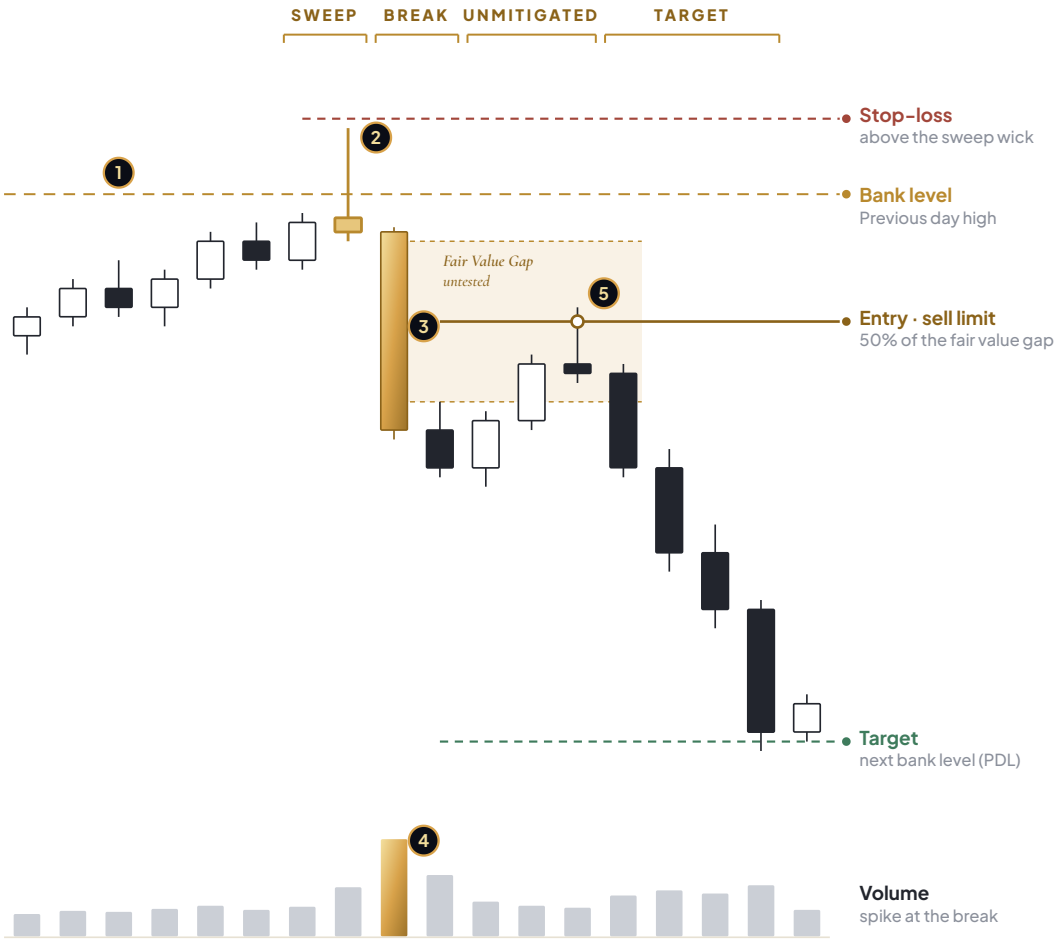


FIG. 6 The complete 1daily Method in a short setup. Schematic illustration, not a trading recommendation.

1 Bank level reached
2 Incomplete candle close
3 Candle larger than the ATR
4 Momentum: volume spike
5 Entry on the retracement

ENTRY

Limit order in the zone

At the edge or at the 50 percent mark of the fair value gap or order block. Never a market order chasing the move.

STOP-LOSS

Beyond the sweep wick

With a small buffer that also allows for the spread. This zone has already been cleared of liquidity. If price returns there, the whole thesis is wrong.

TARGET

Next bank level

The next logical liquidity pool, such as the opposite daily high or low. Not the first paper profit, but the next zone where large orders lie.

Long and short compared

The method is symmetrical. What applies at the high for a short setup applies in mirror image at the low for a long setup.

ELEMENT	SHORT SETUP	LONG SETUP
Bank level	High: previous day, week or Asian high, round number above	Low: previous day, week or Asian low, round number below
Sweep	wick above the high, close below it	wick below the low, close above it
Break	bearish candle larger than the ATR	bullish candle larger than the ATR
Momentum	volume rises, delta negative, bearish divergence	volume rises, delta positive, bullish divergence
Entry	sell limit in the fair value gap or order block	buy limit in the fair value gap or order block
Stop-loss	above the sweep wick	below the sweep wick
Target	next bank level below	next bank level above

The reward-to-risk ratio

RRR = **distance to target** ÷ **distance to stop-loss**

Because the stop-loss sits tight behind the sweep and the target at the next bank level, the SBU sequence produces a favourable ratio by itself. A trade whose target is closer than its stop-loss does not meet this requirement and is not opened.

The sequence in six steps

1. Mark bank levels before trading starts.
2. Wait for the candle to close at the level: sweep confirmed?
3. Compare the counter-candle with the ATR(14).
4. Check volume and delta.
5. Identify the fair value gap or order block, place the limit order.
6. Stop-loss beyond the wick, target at the next bank level, calculate position size.

CHAPTER 09

Trade management

09

From entry to exit: the phase most market participants underestimate.

Trade management is the phase from entry to exit. Closing a position at the first sign of profit while the structural target has not yet been reached follows fear, not the strategy. Letting a loss run follows hope. Over a series, both destroy expectancy.

BEFORE ENTRY

- bank level marked
- five conditions checked
- entry, stop-loss and target defined
- position size calculated
- limit order placed

DURING THE TRADE

- the stop-loss stays where it is
- the target stays where it is
- no additional positions against the plan
- no hedge that merely postpones a loss

AFTER THE TRADE

- result and process in the journal
- emotional costs marked
- daily limit checked
- if tired or frustrated: stop trading

When a setup becomes invalid

- If price reaches the target before the limit order is filled, the order is cancelled.
- If price returns beyond the sweep wick, the thesis is wrong. The stop-loss ends the trade.
- If a high-impact event is imminent, no new positions are opened.
- Once the daily limit of 3% is reached, trading is over for that day.

A missed trade costs nothing

If the bank level is swept but price forms no candle larger than the ATR, the trade is rejected, regardless of the preparation invested. If price runs away without retracing into the untested zone, there is no FOMO entry. The market offers new opportunities every day. Lost capital, by contrast, has to be earned back first.

CHAPTER 10

Economic news

10

The first move is not ours. We trade the confirmation, not the number.

What happens at a release

Gold reacts strongly to macroeconomic data. When highly relevant figures are published, large liquidity providers withdraw from the market for fractions of a second and the order book thins out. As soon as the news is out, high-frequency algorithms fire off massive orders. The result is very large candles within a few seconds. Spreads widen sharply, and market and stop orders are filled with considerable slippage.

The first spike is often deceptive

Many retail traders try to anticipate the number or blindly buy into the first candle. Market history shows, however, that the first move is often deceptive. Price shoots sharply in one direction, takes out an obvious bank level, stops out all early positions and then reverses. Those who trade the number instead of the chart get hit right here.

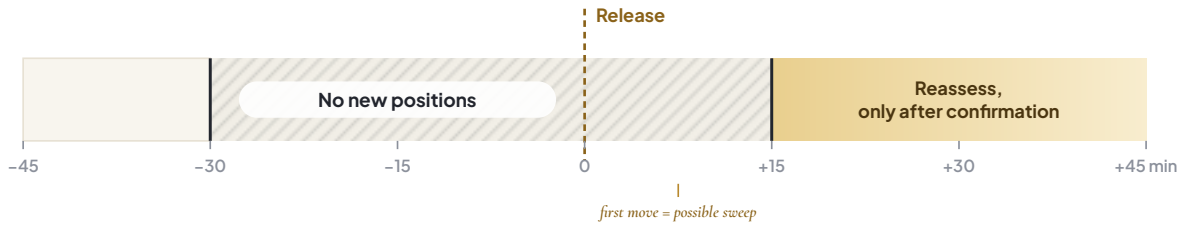


FIG. 7 The time window around a high-impact event. The first move after the release is treated as a possible sweep, not as an entry signal.

The news protocol

1. No new positions are opened in the 30 minutes before a high-impact event.
2. The first volatile move after the release is treated as a possible incomplete candle close.
3. The chart is reassessed no earlier than 15 minutes afterwards, and only once spreads have normalised.
4. If the news candle has left a displacement larger than the ATR after the sweep, the SBU sequence is applied to the retracement that follows.
5. The stop-loss applies without exception, even during unusual moves.

THE MACRO RULE OF THUMB

If US data come in better than expected, that signals a strong economy. It usually strengthens the US dollar, pushes bond yields higher and puts pressure on non-yielding gold. Weaker data usually have the opposite effect.

Without market-moving US data, currency correlations, above all EUR/USD after European releases, often set the direction of the dollar index and therefore, in mirror image, that of gold.

There is never absolute certainty. That is why the macro rule never replaces **confirmation on the chart**.

Key dates for gold

EVENT	FREQUENCY	USUAL TIME (SWISS TIME)	WHY IT MOVES GOLD
US jobs report (NFP)	monthly, usually the first Friday	14:30	employment and wages shape rate expectations
US consumer prices (CPI)	monthly	14:30	inflation decides the central bank's course
US PCE price index	monthly	14:30	the Fed's preferred inflation measure
US rate decision (FOMC)	eight times a year	20:00, press conference 20:30	policy rate and outlook move the dollar and yields
Speeches by Fed leadership	irregular	varies	single sentences can trigger abrupt moves

Swiss time. When the clocks change in the US and Europe on different dates, the times shift by one hour for a few weeks. The economic calendar on the trading day is authoritative.

> **RULE**
>
> **We do not trade the number but the confirmation on the chart. We deliberately miss the very first move.**

CHAPTER 11

Risk management

11

A correct market view is worthless if risk management fails. Capital protection comes before any market opinion.

The rules of risk management are not negotiable. They apply to every trade, every day, regardless of how convincing a setup feels. 1daily Guard enforces them technically, so that they also hold when emotions cloud judgement.

RULE	REQUIREMENT	REASON
Risk per trade	at most 1% of the account	An unavoidable losing streak remains bearable.
Loss per day	at most 3%, then trading stops for the day	Protection against chain reactions on bad days.
Simultaneous positions	at most 3	Focus and a manageable total risk.
Stop-loss	mandatory from entry	Every loss is limited before it occurs.
Moving the stop-loss	never, neither moved nor widened	The stop marks the point where the thesis is wrong.
Position size after losses	no increase	No adding to win back losses.
Economic news	no new positions 30 min. before to 15 min. after high-impact events	Protection against spread widening and slippage.
State of the trader	stop immediately when tired, frustrated or stressed	Exhaustion and emotions impair judgement.

The mathematics of loss

Losses and gains are not symmetrical. Losing 10% requires an 11.1% gain to get back to the starting value. Losing 50% requires 100%. That is why the size of the risk per trade decides whether an unavoidable losing streak remains an episode or endangers the account.

At 1% risk per trade, ten losses in a row cost around 9.6% of the account. At 5% it would be around 40.1%, and recovering would then require a gain of around 67.0%. Small stakes do not protect against losses, but against their consequences.

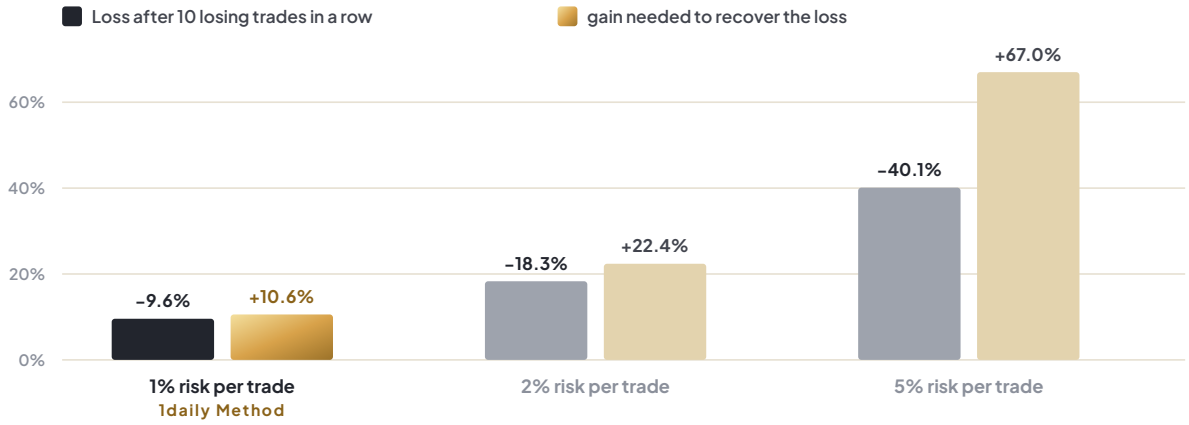


FIG. 8 Loss after ten losing trades in a row and the gain needed to recover it. Calculated with a fixed risk as a percentage of the current account balance.

LOSS	GAIN NEEDED
10%	11.1%
20%	25.0%
30%	42.9%
50%	100%
75%	300%

Three things that never happen

Never move it. A stop-loss is never moved or widened. It marks the point where the thesis is wrong, not the point where the pain becomes too great.

Never add to losers. No larger positions to win back losses. Increasing risk after losses puts the account at stake exactly when judgement is at its weakest.

Never trade tired. Trading stops immediately when tired, frustrated or emotionally stressed. The market will be open again tomorrow.

CHAPTER 12

Position sizing

12

The stop-loss follows market structure. Position size follows the stop-loss. That keeps the risk the same in every market.

In many trading approaches a position size is chosen first and the stop-loss is then set at a round distance, say 20 pips. The 1daily Method works the other way round. The stop-loss sits where market structure requires it: beyond the sweep wick.

Only then is the position size calculated so that a triggered stop costs exactly the defined amount. With most providers one standard lot of XAUUSD is 100 troy ounces: a move of USD 1 changes a 1.0 lot position by USD 100.

$$\text{Lot size} = \frac{\text{Account balance} \times \text{risk per trade}}{\text{Stop distance in USD} \times 100}$$

A worked example

Account balance	USD 50,000
Risk per trade (1%)	USD 500
Stop distance to beyond the sweep wick	USD 6.40
Lot size: 500 ÷ (6.40 × 100)	**0.78 lot**
Loss at stop: 0.78 × 6.40 × 100	USD 499.20
Distance to the next bank level	USD 14.10
Potential gain: 0.78 × 14.10 × 100	USD 1,099.80
Reward-to-risk ratio	**about 2.2**

The lot size is rounded down to the next tradable step, never up. Spread and commission slightly increase the effective loss and are factored in in practice.

The same risk at any volatility

STOP DISTANCE	MARKET PHASE	LOTS	LOSS AT STOP
USD 2	low volatility	5.00	USD 1,000
USD 5	normal volatility	2.00	USD 1,000
USD 10	high volatility	1.00	USD 1,000
USD 20	news spike	0.50	USD 1,000

Example with an account of USD 100,000 and 1% risk per trade, excluding spread and commission.

CHAPTER 13

AI, people and system

13

Artificial intelligence analyses. People trade. The system protects.

ANALYSE

Goldcheck

- combines technicals, institutional factors, macro and news
- signal from Strong Sell to Strong Buy with a confidence score
- actively "No Trade" when uncertainty is high

TRADE

The trader

- checks the five conditions on the chart
- sets entry, stop-loss and target
- decides and carries the responsibility

PROTECT

1daily Guard

- enforces the risk rules technically
- steps in before a limit is breached
- protects when emotions are strongest

Goldcheck: analysis in six layers

LAYER	TASK	RESULT
1 · Technical Engine	moving averages, RSI, MACD, ATR and other oscillators	technical score from –100 to +100
2 · Institutional Engine	VWAP, futures, volume, open interest, market structure	institutional score
3 · Macro Engine	dollar index, US yields, real rates, EUR/USD, ETF flows	macro score
4 · AI News Engine	assessment of news and event risks	news impact and event risk
5 · Confidence Engine	agreement and quality of all signals	confidence from 0 to 100%
6 · Signal & Trade Engine	consolidation and output	signal and optional trade parameters

How Goldcheck supports the method

Goldcheck is not a charting tool but a decision aid. Technical signals are never viewed in isolation but cross-checked against macro data, futures, volume and news. The weighting depends on the timeframe: on short timeframes liquidity, VWAP and market structure dominate; on longer ones the dollar, yields and positioning.

Goldcheck thus provides exactly the context the method requires: where are the relevant price zones? How high is current volatility? Is an event risk imminent? Do macro and technicals point in the same direction?

Goldcheck does not promise profits. Every output is an analysis, not a guarantee. When uncertainty is high the system actively outputs “No Trade”, no aggressive signal appears before high-impact events without a warning, and missing data are shown transparently.

People remain responsible

Artificial intelligence is not a substitute for human judgement but an amplifier of it. It analyses data, recognises patterns and filters noise so that people can do what machines cannot: weigh up, decide and take responsibility. A Goldcheck signal alone is never a reason for a trade. The five conditions are decisive.

1DAILY GUARD

The system that protects

1daily Guard works directly on the trading platform and enforces the method’s risk rules technically. This means capital protection does not depend on the trader’s form on the day.

1% maximum risk per trade	**3%** daily loss limit, then trading stops	**3** positions at the same time	**Stop** stop-loss mandatory from entry
No adding no larger positions after losses	**Pause** enforced pause after losses against revenge trading	**News block** no new positions around high-impact events	**Time window** trading only within defined hours

CHAPTER 14

The trading day

14

The method in the daily routine: preparation, execution and review as a fixed habit.

Discipline comes from repetition. A fixed daily routine ensures that the method does not depend on mood but becomes a habit. The following routine shows a typical trading day in Swiss time.

PREPARATION

Before the open

- check the economic calendar, mark high-impact events
- draw previous day's high and low, weekly extremes and round numbers
- read the Goldcheck bias on higher timeframes
- note account balance, risk per trade and daily limit

OBSERVE

Asian session

- follow the session's high and low
- these extremes later become bank levels
- do not force trades in quiet phases
- keep an eye on the ATR of the trading timeframe

FIRST OPPORTUNITIES

London open

- add the Asian high and low as bank levels
- watch for sweeps at the marked levels
- trade only when all five conditions are met
- place limit orders with stop-loss and target

NEWS PROTOCOL

Around data

- no new positions 30 minutes before high-impact events
- treat the first move as a possible sweep
- reassess after 15 minutes at the earliest
- respect the stop-loss without exception

HIGHEST LIQUIDITY

London and New York

- sweeps and displacements are clearest
- at most three positions at the same time
- keep checking the 3% daily limit
- observe the pause after a loss

REVIEW

After trading

- record every trade in the journal
- mark emotional costs honestly
- note one insight for the next day
- when tired, stop earlier, never later

CHAPTER 15

The checklist

15

Before every trade. Without exception. If a single item is not met, there is no trade.

A Preparation

- [ ] bank levels marked before trading starts
- [ ] no high-impact event in the next 30 minutes
- [ ] daily loss below 3%, fewer than three open positions
- [ ] rested, focused, no frustration from the last trade

B The five conditions

- [ ] 1 · price at a marked bank level
- [ ] 2 · candle closed, wick beyond, close back inside the range
- [ ] 3 · counter-candle larger than the ATR(14) of the same timeframe
- [ ] 4 · volume well above average, delta in the new direction
- [ ] 5 · untested zone (fair value gap or order block) identified

C Execution

- [ ] entry as a limit order at the edge or 50 percent mark of the zone
- [ ] stop-loss beyond the sweep wick, with buffer and spread
- [ ] target at the next bank level
- [ ] target further away than the stop-loss

D Risk

- [ ] position size calculated with the formula, at most 1%
- [ ] stop-loss in the market from entry
- [ ] no increase after losses
- [ ] no hedge that merely postpones a loss

E After the trade

- [ ] trade recorded in the journal
- [ ] emotional costs marked
- [ ] daily limit checked
- [ ] insight for tomorrow noted

APPENDIX

Glossary

ATR (Average True Range)
Average true trading range over a period, by default 14 candles. A measure of volatility without direction.

Bank level
Price zone where large market participants find liquidity: round numbers and previous day, week and session extremes.

Bid and ask
Selling and buying price. The difference is the spread.

Break of structure
A break of the local market structure, such as falling below the last swing low.

CFD
Contract for difference. Tracks the price movement without physical delivery. The difference between entry and exit is settled.

COT report
Weekly report from the US regulator CFTC on positioning in the futures market.

Cumulative delta
Running difference between aggressive buying and selling.

Displacement
An unusually large, directional candle that shows institutional pressure.

EMA
Exponential moving average. Gives more weight to recent prices.

Emotional costs
Measurable costs of rule violations driven by fear, greed, frustration or hope.

Fair value gap
Price gap between the wick of the candle before and the candle after a strong move. A zone with hardly any trading.

FOMC
Federal Open Market Committee of the US Federal Reserve. Decides on the policy rate.

Incomplete candle close
A candle pierces a level but closes back inside the range. The footprint of a sweep.

Liquidity sweep
A brief piercing of a level that triggers clustered stop orders, which are absorbed by opposing orders.

Lot
Trading unit. With most providers one standard lot of XAUUSD is 100 troy ounces.

MACD
Moving Average Convergence Divergence. Shows trend changes and acceleration.

NFP
Non-Farm Payrolls, the monthly US jobs report.

Order block
The last candle before a strong counter-move. A possible entry zone.

PDH and PDL
Previous day high and low.

RRR
Reward-to-risk ratio: distance to target divided by distance to stop-loss.

RSI
Relative Strength Index. Momentum oscillator from 0 to 100.

SBU
Sweep, break, unmitigated: the execution sequence of the 1daily Method.

Slippage
Difference between the intended and the actual execution price.

Spread
Difference between buying and selling price.

Stop-loss
An order set in advance that limits a loss.

Tick volume
Number of price changes per period. A proxy for volume in the decentralised spot market.

Unmitigated
Untested: a zone that price has not returned to since it formed.

VWAP
Volume-weighted average price of a trading session.

Wick
The part of a candle outside its body. Shows prices that were reached but not held.

XAUUSD
Gold against the US dollar: the price of one troy ounce in US dollars.

APPENDIX

Risk warning

CFDs are complex instruments and come with a high risk of losing money rapidly due to leverage. A large share of retail investor accounts lose money when trading CFDs. You should consider whether you understand how CFDs work and whether you can afford to take the high risk of losing your money.

The 1daily Method and Goldcheck are for information and analysis only. They do not constitute investment advice, a recommendation to buy or sell financial instruments or a promise of profit. All examples and charts in this document are schematic and serve as illustrations.

Past performance and historical patterns are not a reliable indicator of future results. Even a consistently applied set of rules cannot prevent losses and longer losing streaks. A stop-loss limits losses but may be executed at a worse price during sharp price jumps or low liquidity.

1daily AG does not provide financial services that require a licence. Anyone who trades bears full responsibility for their own decisions.

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